MONTHLY UPDATE

ICT Industry: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *14 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.*

ALGERIA · ANGOLA · CENTRAL AFRICAN REPUBLIC · EGYPT · ESWATINI · KENYA · MADAGASCAR · MAURITIUS · MOZAMBIQUE · NIGERIA · SENEGAL · SOUTH AFRICA · TANZANIA · UGANDA

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

The state electronics firm INATEL, in a consortium with two other companies, signed a protocol with the coordination of a Congolese new-city expansion project for digital technologies, electronic payment systems, digital equipment and associated services, with knowledge transfer and a centre for innovation covering payment systems, cybersecurity and applied artificial intelligence, before Algeria's ambassador. No amount is stated by any party. The firm had previously exported electronic payment terminals to Nigeria.

Angola

The sector was given a growth rate and nothing to read it against. The secretary of state for telecommunications told the close of the seventeenth technology innovation fair that the telecommunications, information technology and media sector grew 14.3% in its contribution to gross domestic product in the second quarter of 2026, among the five best-performing sectors. It is a rate given in a speech: no level, no base, no statistical release, and a sector that bundles media with telecommunications and IT.

Central African Republic

The regulator published operators' combined revenue for the first half of 2026 in its market observatory. It is turnover reported to the regulator; no contribution to output, employment or firm count is held.

Egypt

Opening the sixth Tech Invest Egypt conference on 7 September, the communications minister put outsourcing exports at US$5.1bn at end-2025 against a target of US$8bn by 2028, and sector growth at 24.3% in the fourth quarter of 2025/26; on 9 September he put handset production at about 10 million in 2025, from 3 million in 2024.

A US outsourcing firm opened an AI-powered delivery hub in Cairo on 17 September, planning to grow from about 135 staff to 1,365 over three years. An Egyptian enterprise AI company expanded into Bahrain with a local operator (10 September), a Jordanian education platform acquired an Egyptian maker of tutoring-centre software (2 September), price not stated, and a B2B fashion marketplace reported about EGP 40m transacted since launch (10 August).

Eswatini

A state-facing platform changed hands rather than being built. The Taiwan-funded platform connecting local businesses to wider markets was handed over to the investment promotion authority at the international trade fair on 3 September, with funding for a third-phase scale-up still being sought. No listing count, transaction volume, cost or phase-three budget is published, so what the state has taken on is a platform whose running costs are unstated.

Kenya

The Kenyan business of a pan-African backbone owner is repositioning from connectivity provider to a layered artificial-intelligence, cloud and cybersecurity business on top of its own network, its chief executive arguing on 10 September that connectivity becomes the foundation of digital infrastructure rather than the product. He put Africa at 0.6% of world data-centre capacity, the concern he said African telecom executives raise most. It is a stated strategy in two interviews at one conference: no revenue split, investment figure, capacity addition or service launch date accompanies it.

The state's largest telecoms divestment was undone in court and is heading back there. The High Court voided the sale of a 15% Safaricom stake to Vodacom on 15 September, and on 16 September Vodacom said it would appeal and seek a stay, and the finance minister said the Treasury would appeal too. How the proceeds already committed are treated is not on record. A press report of the company's accounts showed the device financier completing its US$8m acquisition of a Finnish device-locking software company.

Madagascar

The government outsourcing-skills programme certified 99 of the 111 trainees in its second seven-week cohort on 24 September, delivered with a private academy under a World Bank-supported project. No placement figure is published, so what the cohort shows is completion rather than jobs.

Mauritius

The month’s industry news is a stake, not a product. A pan-African investment fund took a minority holding in a Mauritian digital transformation consultancy, with no sum disclosed. Neither the stake size, the use of proceeds nor a holding period is stated.

Mozambique

The state is looking for a partner to take part of its telecommunications operator. Government opened the selection of a strategic investor to take part of the state's shareholding, seeking financial, technological and management capacity, with a multisectoral technical team running the negotiation. No stake size, valuation or timetable is published.

Nigeria

The communications minister put the ICT sector's contribution to GDP at about 21 per cent, up from about 16 per cent in three years. A consultancy procurement opened on 21 September for a programme to build a knowledge-services export industry, with a 1,000-graduate academy. The software industry association committed on 10 September to launch a national software industry registry within six months. OPay filed a registration statement in the United States on 9 October 2026 for a New York listing. The filing shows a South African banking group's unit buying up to US$200m of shares in a private placement alongside the offering, and 50.1 million monthly active users at end-July 2026.

Senegal

A French insurance-technology company acquired Tanel, a Senegalese health-technology firm, in what the account calls a rare francophone health-technology exit. No price, range or cash-and-stock split was disclosed by either side and the company's revenue was withheld, so nothing here can be put against the sector's other exits. What the transaction does establish is a buyer outside the region taking a Senegalese health platform, which is the first such disposal on this ledger. The telecommunications ministry is pooling public bodies' equipment demand so that local assemblers can win state contracts, and visited a private assembly unit with a pilot capacity of about 7,500 computers a year; no contract, volume or budget is stated. The telecommunications ministry signed a US$150m partnership convention for local production of electronic devices; no financing schedule is stated.

South Africa

Online retail crossed 10 per cent of national retail turnover in June 2026 and is forecast at ZAR 159 billion for the year, on the study publisher's own account; the same study reports growth in cross-border e-commerce significantly slowed by the crackdown on low-value imports. Two fibre network operators confirmed merger talks, reported on 18 September; nothing is finalised. A bank's mobile virtual network reported 1.02 million subscriber identities and R3bn of gross revenue. The largest domestic operator lifted its effective interest in the Kenyan incumbent from 35 to 55 per cent on 30 June 2026, through a state share sale a Kenyan court has since voided.

The largest bank by assets signed a subscription agreement to invest in a Nigerian digital financial platform, to close with or shortly after that platform's proposed New York listing; no amount is stated.

Tanzania

The sector has multiplied and says it cannot scale. A United Nations capital development fund counts 171 active fintech companies in 2026 against 33 in 2021, alongside more than 70 per cent of adults holding a mobile money account and 6.4 billion digital payment transactions in 2024, and founders told a Dar es Salaam session that partnerships with banks and mobile operators remain the main barrier - banks assessing early-stage firms through a static lens, the core processing layer commoditised as institutions build in house, limited patient capital, talent shortages, regulatory and tax uncertainty and the cost of acquiring customers. The stated ambition is to be a leading African fintech market by 2031, with no intermediate target on file.

One account of the trading economy the fintech count sits above reached the repository: an e-commerce sector that runs on an Instagram storefront, a WhatsApp sales desk, a mobile-money rail, a motorcycle courier for the last mile and long-distance buses across the border, rather than on platforms with catalogues and checkout. It is a reported description rather than a measurement, and the repository holds no transaction volume, merchant count or dispute mechanism for any part of it.

Uganda

One domestic firm passed into foreign ownership, and the consideration is not on the record. A Nigerian technology company acquired a Ugandan banking-software firm, bringing every stage of credit — from verifying the borrower's identity to repayment — onto a single platform, the companies saying the combination lets African financial institutions assess loan applications faster and lend more readily. No price is disclosed, and no revenue, customer count, headcount or regulatory clearance is published for either party — so what left the country cannot be sized.

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